Figure 1. Spending

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
General												
Overall population (in millions)	US 342	Japan 123	Germany 83	UK 69	France 69	Canada 42	Australia 28	NLD 18	Sweden 11	CHE 9	Denmark 6	73
Population ≥65 y, %	Japan 29.4	Germany 22.9	France 22.0	Sweden 21.5	NLD 21.0	Denmark 21.0	CHE 19.7	Canada 19.5	UK 19.3	US 18.9	Australia 17.5	21.2
GDP per capita, US $ (in thousands)	CHE 102.49	US 89.98	NLD 86.66	Denmark 84.75	Germany 75.39	Australia 75.21	Sweden 72.92	Canada 66.86	UK 64.47	France 63.97	Japan 55.49	76.20
Land area (× 1000 sq km)[a]	US 9147	Canada 8789	Australia 7692	France 539	Sweden 407	Japan 365	Germany 349	UK 242	Denmark 40	CHE 40	NLD 34	2513
Poverty rate, % below poverty line of 60%	US 25	Japan 21	Australia 20	Canada 19	UK 18	Germany 18	CHE 16	Sweden 16	France 15	NLD 15	Denmark 13	18
Health spending												
Total spending on health, % of total national GDP	US 16.7	Germany 12.3	CHE 11.7	France 11.5	Canada 11.3	Sweden 11.2	UK 11.1	Japan 10.7	Australia 10.4	NLD 10.0	Denmark 9.4	11.5
Public spending on health, % of total national GDP[b]	Sweden 9.6	Germany 9.3	Japan 9.1	US 9.0	UK 9.0	Canada 7.9	France 7.9	Denmark 7.8	Australia 7.7	NLD 6.7	CHE 3.9	8.0
Mean spending on health per capita, US $[c]	US 13 473	CHE 10 602	Germany 8826	NLD 8195	Sweden 7770	Australia 7691	Canada 7646	Denmark 7262	France 6868	UK 6606	Japan 5365	8209
Health expenditure by function of care as a % of total national health expenditure[d]												
Inpatient care	Japan 26	Australia 26	Germany 25	France 25	UK 25	CHE 23	Denmark 22	Sweden 20	US 17	Canada 15	NLD 15	22
Outpatient care	US 45	Denmark 39	NLD 35	Australia 35	Canada 32	UK 32	Sweden 30	Japan 28	France 25	CHE 25	Germany 21	31
Long-term care	NLD 30	Sweden 28	Canada 22	Germany 22	CHE 22	Denmark 22	UK 20	Japan 19	France 16	Australia 14	US 8	20
Medical goods	Germany 18	Japan 18	France 17	Canada 17	Australia 15	CHE 15	US 13	Sweden 12	Denmark 12	UK 11	NLD 10	14
Governance and administration	US 9	France 5	CHE 4	Germany 4	Denmark 4	Canada 3	NLD 3	Australia 3	UK 2	Japan 1	Sweden 1	4
Home-based care	France 4	UK 3	Japan 3	Sweden 1	NLD 1	Germany 1	Canada 0	Australia 0	US NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	1 (n = 8)
Preventive care	Canada 6	UK 5	NLD 5	Japan 4	Germany 4	US 3	Sweden 3	France 3	Denmark 2	Australia 2	CHE 2	4
Other	CHE 10	US 6	France 6	Australia 6	Sweden 5	Germany 5	Canada 4	UK 3	NLD 3	Japan 1	Denmark 0	4
Population with health care coverage, %[e]	UK 100.0	Sweden 100.0	CHE 100.0	Denmark 100.0	Canada 100.0	Japan 100.0	Australia 100.0	Germany 99.9	France 99.9	NLD 99.8	US 91.7	99.2

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Land area excludes inland waters (World Bank AG.LND.TOTL.K2). The 2018 figure used total surface area, a series that now also includes coastal waters for Canada, France, and Sweden.

[b] Domestic general government health expenditure, including social health insurance (WHO GHED). Mandatory basic insurance premiums in Switzerland and the Netherlands are now classified as compulsory private prepayment and are excluded, so these 2 values are not comparable with 2018.

[c] Current health expenditure per capita in current international dollars (purchasing power parities).

[d] OECD System of Health Accounts, share of current health expenditure; day care is included in outpatient care and Other is ancillary plus unallocated services. US values are for 2018, the latest year the US reports an inpatient/outpatient split, without the 2018 paper's adjustment for observation stays. Netherlands has a 2021 series break.

[e] US: insured share of the population, CDC National Health Interview Survey early release 2025; other countries, OECD total public and primary private coverage.

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2018–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: World Bank World Development Indicators (population, land area); OECD Data Explorer (population ≥65 y, GDP per capita [Productivity database], poverty [Income Distribution Database], health expenditure by function [System of Health Accounts], coverage); WHO Global Health Expenditure Database via World Bank (total, public, and per capita health spending); US coverage, CDC National Health Interview Survey 2025.

Figure 4. Population Health

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Determinants of health												
Smoking, % of population aged ≥15 y who smoke daily	France 18.2	CHE 16.1	Japan 14.8	Germany 14.0	NLD 12.0	Denmark 11.0	UK 9.1	Australia 8.5	Sweden 8.4	Canada 8.2	US 7.4	11.6
Alcohol consumption, L per capita in population aged ≥15 y	Germany 10.2	France 9.8	Australia 9.8	US 9.4	Denmark 9.1	UK 8.8	Canada 8.1	CHE 7.6	Sweden 7.3	NLD 7.3	Japan 6.7	8.6
Obese or overweight, % of population aged ≥15 y	US 72.2	UK 64.2	Australia 64.0	Canada 59.8	Germany 53.4[b]	Sweden 53.0[a]	Denmark 52.9[a]	NLD 48.7[a]	France 46.4	CHE 42.9[a]	Japan 25.3	53.0
Life expectancy												
Life expectancy in total population at birth, mean, y	CHE 84.2	Japan 84.1	Sweden 83.8	France 83.0	Australia 83.0	Canada 82.2	Denmark 82.0	NLD 81.9	UK 81.3	Germany 81.2	US 79.0	82.3
Health-adjusted life expectancy, mean, y[c]	Japan 73.4	CHE 71.2	Sweden 71.1	Australia 70.6	France 70.1	Denmark 70.1	NLD 70.0	Canada 69.8	Germany 68.9	UK 68.6	US 63.9	69.8
Life expectancy for women aged ≥40 y, mean, y	Japan 47.9	France 46.6	CHE 46.6	Sweden 45.9	Australia 45.9	Canada 45.4	Denmark 44.6	UK 44.2	Germany 44.2	NLD 44.0	US 42.9	45.3
Life expectancy for men aged ≥40 y, mean, y	CHE 43.4	Sweden 43.2	Australia 42.4	Japan 42.0	Canada 41.8	France 41.6	NLD 41.5	Denmark 41.2	UK 40.7	Germany 39.9	US 39.0	41.5
Maternal and infant health												
Maternal mortality, deaths per 100 000 live births[d]	US 17.9	Canada 12.6	UK 8.3	France 8.2	Australia 8.1	CHE 7.7	Sweden 5.2	Germany 4.4	Japan 4.4	NLD 3.6	Denmark 0.0	7.3
Infant mortality, deaths per 1000 live births	US 5.5	Canada 4.5	UK 4.2	France 4.0	Germany 3.3	NLD 3.3	CHE 3.3	Australia 3.3	Denmark 2.3	Sweden 2.0	Japan 1.8	3.4
Neonatal mortality, deaths per 1000 live births	US 3.7	Canada 3.3	UK 3.1	France 2.9	CHE 2.7	NLD 2.6	Germany 2.4	Australia 2.4	Denmark 1.9	Sweden 1.4	Japan 0.9	2.5
Neonatal mortality, deaths per 1000 live births excluding <1000 g[e]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Low birth weight, % of total live births	Japan 9.8	US 8.5	France 7.5	UK 7.2	Canada 7.2	Germany 6.6	Australia 6.6	CHE 6.0	NLD 5.6	Denmark 4.6	Sweden 4.1	6.7

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

[a] Patient self-reported data.

[b] Self-reported; the latest measured value for Germany is from 2012.

[c] WHO estimates for 2021 (current revision, which places levels about 2 to 3 years below the estimates published in 2017; includes COVID-19 mortality).

[d] OECD registry-based rates for all countries, including Canada (the 2018 paper used Global Burden of Disease estimates for Canada and model-based values for several countries). Small numbers make annual rates volatile.

[e] No current source reports neonatal mortality excluding births under 1000 g for these countries (the 2018 values came from a 2012 study of 2004 data); not updated.

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2013–2025; most values 2023–2024); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD Data Explorer (Health Statistics: risk factors, life expectancy, maternal and infant mortality, low birth weight); WHO Global Health Observatory (health-adjusted life expectancy).

Figure 5. Workforce and Structural Capacity

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Practicing workforce												
Overall physicians per 1000 population	Germany 4.8	Sweden 4.7	CHE 4.7	Denmark 4.7	Australia 4.3	NLD 4.0	France 3.9	UK 3.5	US 2.7	Canada 2.7	Japan 2.7	3.9
Primary care physicians, % of total	Canada 51	NLD 48	Australia 44	France 38	CHE 31	UK 29	Germany 27	US 21	Denmark 21	Sweden 15	Japan NA	32 (n = 10)
Specialists, % of total	Sweden 85	Denmark 79	US 79	Germany 73	UK 71	CHE 69	France 62	Australia 56	NLD 52	Canada 50	Japan NA	67 (n = 10)
Nurses per 1000 population	CHE 19.0	Australia 13.4	US 12.6[e]	Japan 12.6	Germany 12.5	NLD 11.2	Sweden 11.1	Denmark 10.5	Canada 10.2	UK 9.3	France 8.9	11.9
Workforce remuneration, US $												
Generalist physicians[b]	US 298 000	Germany 290 314	UK 248 913	CHE 239 612	France 194 521	Canada 194 315	NLD 186 939	Japan 153 308[a]	Sweden 143 102	Denmark 140 656	Australia 139 970	202 695
Specialist physicians[b]	US 417 000	Canada 304 083	CHE 266 632	NLD 244 321	Australia 238 134	Germany 229 534	UK 201 171	Denmark 190 450	France 146 823	Sweden 137 526	Japan NA	237 567 (n = 10)
Nurses[b]	US 103 729	NLD 99 132	Australia 88 764	Denmark 83 031	Germany 81 723	CHE 76 257	Canada 73 522	Sweden 62 900	France 61 767	UK 58 187	Japan 53 668	76 607
Non-health-specific annual wage, mean[c]	CHE 92 285	US 86 977	NLD 80 136	Denmark 78 090	Germany 76 285	Australia 72 018	Canada 67 901	UK 66 299	Sweden 61 443	France 60 483	Japan 50 183	72 009
Ratio of generalist remuneration to mean wage[d]	Germany 3.9	UK 3.7	US 3.4	France 3.4	Canada 2.8	CHE 2.7	NLD 2.3	Sweden 2.3	Australia 1.9	Denmark 1.8	Japan NA	2.8 (n = 10)
Ratio of specialists remuneration to mean wage[d]	US 4.8	Canada 4.4	UK 3.4	Australia 3.3	NLD 3.1	Germany 3.0	CHE 2.9	Denmark 2.4	France 2.4	Sweden 2.2	Japan NA	3.2 (n = 10)
Ratio of nurse remuneration to mean wage[d]	NLD 1.22	Australia 1.22	US 1.21	Germany 1.14	Canada 1.06	Denmark 1.04	Japan 1.03	Sweden 1.00	France 0.99	UK 0.87	CHE 0.84	1.06
Equipment per 1 million population												
Magnetic resonance imaging units	Japan 59.8	US 38.0	Germany 37.9	France 20.6	Australia 20.0	Sweden 17.9	Denmark 16.1	NLD 15.4	Canada 10.4	UK 9.4	CHE NA	24.5 (n = 10)
Computed tomography units	Japan 119.8	Australia 80.0	US 42.6	CHE 40.6	Germany 38.0	Denmark 29.1	Sweden 23.6	France 21.9	NLD 17.5	Canada 14.2	UK 10.9	39.8
Mammography machine units	US 77.7	Japan 33.5	CHE 29.3	Australia 19.7	Canada 16.7	Denmark 16.4	Sweden 11.0	UK 7.3	Germany NA	France NA	NLD NA	26.4 (n = 8)
Beds												
Hospital beds per 1000 population	Japan 12.5	Germany 7.6	France 5.3	CHE 4.2	Australia 3.8	US 2.7	UK 2.4	Canada 2.4	NLD 2.2	Denmark 2.1	Sweden 1.9	4.3
Long-term beds per 1000 population aged ≥65 y[f]	NLD 68.0	Sweden 63.1	CHE 58.3	Germany 53.0	France 45.1	Australia 44.7	Canada 43.2	UK 41.0	Denmark 35.0	US 27.2	Japan 26.9	46.0

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right. Primary care physicians are generalist medical practitioners plus general pediatricians as a share of all physicians (OECD); unlike the 2018 functionality-based definition, general internists and geriatricians are counted as specialists because they cannot be separated in OECD or Eurostat data. Remuneration numbers may be an underestimate in some countries (eg, Canada) because they do not account for practice expenses for self-employed physicians.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Combined generalist and specialist figure for Japan (salaried physicians in general hospitals); Japan is excluded from the generalist and specialist ratios.

[b] Annual remuneration in current-price US dollar purchasing power parities for the latest year, converted to 2025 US dollars with the US Consumer Price Index (CPI-U), as in the 2018 paper. US values are average total compensation (Medscape) and are not from OECD.

[c] In 2025 constant prices at 2025 US dollar purchasing power parities.

[d] Remuneration divided by the average annual wage for the same country and year (both in current-price US dollar purchasing power parities).

[e] Professionally active nurses; the US does not report practising nurses.

[f] Beds in long-term care institutions only (OECD no longer publishes institutions plus hospitals).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2016–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD Data Explorer (Health Statistics: physicians by category, nurses, remuneration of health professionals, medical technology, hospital and long-term care beds; average annual wages); US physician remuneration, Medscape Physician Compensation Report 2026 (2025 earnings); Japan, Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare Survey on Economic Conditions in Health Care (FY2024); US CPI-U, Bureau of Labor Statistics.

Figure 7. Utilization

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Discharges per 100 000 population												
Acute myocardial infarction[a]	Germany 244	US 192	Australia 189	Sweden 186	CHE 180	NLD 168	UK 165	France 162	Canada 155	Denmark 104	Japan 57	164
Mental and behavioral[b]	Germany 1553	CHE 1190	France 1051	Australia 965	Denmark 962	Sweden 882	US 678	Canada 642	UK 286	Japan 277	NLD 42	775
Pneumonia	Germany 492	UK 486	Denmark 445	Australia 400	Sweden 379	US 364	CHE 360	France 331	Japan 320	Canada 210	NLD 183	361
Chronic obstructive pulmonary disease	Germany 302	Australia 257	UK 254	US 230	Canada 210	Denmark 196	NLD 157	CHE 151	France 141	Sweden 121	Japan 40	187
Examinations per 1000 population												
Magnetic resonance imaging[c]	Germany 167	France 163	Japan 112	US 108	CHE 91	Denmark 89	UK 75	NLD 60	Canada 57	Australia 56	Sweden NA	98 (n = 10)
Computed tomography	US 254	France 241	Japan 231	Denmark 204	Australia 188	Germany 176	Canada 164	CHE 140	NLD 138	UK 133	Sweden NA	187 (n = 10)
Surgical procedures												
Total hip replacement per 100 000 population	Germany 359	CHE 358	Denmark 297	Sweden 280	France 273	NLD 268	UK 224	Australia 211	US 204	Canada 192	Japan NA	267 (n = 10)
Total knee replacement per 100 000 population	CHE 328	Germany 288	Denmark 264	Australia 259	Canada 231	US 226	France 210	Sweden 175	UK 170	NLD 164	Japan NA	232 (n = 10)
Hysterectomy per 100 000 women[d]	CHE 264	Australia 240	Germany 226	Canada 220	France 169	UK 142	Sweden 138	Denmark 129	NLD 96	US NA	Japan NA	180 (n = 9)
Cesarean delivery per 100 live births	Australia 41	UK 40	CHE 34	Canada 33	US 32	Germany 32	France 22	Denmark 20	Sweden 19	NLD 16	Japan NA	29 (n = 10)
Cataract surgery per 100 000 population	France 1639	Denmark 1435	NLD 1306	Australia 1284	Germany 1276	Sweden 1261	UK 1246	Canada 1088	CHE 470	US NA	Japan NA	1223 (n = 9)
Cardiovascular procedures per 100 000 population												
Coronary artery bypass graft surgery	US 79	Canada 47	Germany 45	Australia 45	NLD 44	CHE 37	France 26	Sweden 23	Denmark 23	UK 20	Japan NA	39 (n = 10)
Coronary angioplasty	Germany 392	CHE 325	France 299	NLD 210	Australia 177	Sweden 162	Denmark 148	Canada 126	UK 123	US NA	Japan NA	218 (n = 9)
Length of stay per capita, mean, d												
Normal delivery	France 3.9	Germany 2.9	CHE 2.7	Australia 2.4	Sweden 2.3	Denmark 2.2	US 2.0	NLD 1.6	UK 1.5	Canada 1.5	Japan NA	2.3 (n = 10)
Acute myocardial infarction	Germany 8.8	UK 7.7	CHE 6.4	US 5.4	Canada 5.3	France 5.1	Australia 4.5	NLD 4.2	Denmark 4.2	Sweden 3.8	Japan NA	5.5 (n = 10)

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] The latest OECD data for the United States are from 2009 to 2010 for discharges, surgical and cardiovascular procedures, and length of stay (the 2018 paper also used 2010). Japan no longer reports surgical procedures or length of stay by diagnosis.

[b] France includes psychiatric hospital stays from 2016 onward; the Netherlands still excludes psychiatric hospitals. Denmark's discharge and length-of-stay data follow a 2019 registry change.

[c] United Kingdom and Switzerland include hospital examinations only; Australia includes only examinations eligible for public reimbursement.

[d] US hysterectomy and coronary angioplasty are NA because OECD US data cover inpatient cases only (2010) and exclude the large share performed as outpatient procedures; the 2018 paper used HCUP data including outpatient angioplasty.

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2009–2025; most values 2022–2024); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Source: OECD Data Explorer (Health Statistics: hospital discharges, diagnostic exams, surgical procedures, average length of stay).

Figure 9. Pharmaceuticals

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Total spending per capita, US $[a]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Retail pharmaceutical spending per capita, US $[b]	US 1752	Germany 1338	CHE 1193	Canada 1064	Japan 1026	Australia 947	France 851	Sweden 756	UK 635	NLD 568	Denmark 535	970
Prices, US $ per mo[d]												
Crestor (cholesterol)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Lantus (diabetes)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Advair (asthma)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Humira (rheumatoid arthritis)	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
New chemical entities, No.[c]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Pharmaceutical expenditure by financing type, % of total spending[e]												
Public spending	Germany 83	France 82	CHE 73	Japan 71	UK 70	NLD 69	Sweden 57	Australia 50	Denmark 39	Canada 36	US NA	63 (n = 10)
Private insurance	Canada 34	Denmark 6	France 6	CHE 4	Japan 1	NLD 1	Australia 0	Germany 0	UK 0	Sweden 0	US NA	5 (n = 10)
Private out-of-pocket spending	Denmark 55	Australia 50	Sweden 44	NLD 31	Canada 30	US 30	UK 30	Japan 28	CHE 24	Germany 16	France 13	32
Share of generics, % of total[g]												
Volume	Germany 84	Canada 79	NLD 79	UK 73	Australia 71	Denmark 70	Japan 54	France 43	Sweden 34	CHE 27	US NA	62 (n = 10)
Value	Germany 28	NLD 27	UK 27	Denmark 24	Canada 23	CHE 21	France 18	Sweden 17	Japan 17	Australia 16	US NA	22 (n = 10)
Antibiotic prescribing, defined daily doses per 1000 population[f]	France 24.7	Australia 19.3	UK 15.6	Denmark 14.4	Germany 12.1	Canada 10.5	Japan 9.9	Sweden 9.6	NLD 9.0	US NA	CHE NA	13.9 (n = 9)

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Not updated: no public source reports total (retail plus hospital) pharmaceutical spending per capita on a common basis for most of these countries (the 2018 values came from IMS/IFPMA).

[b] Retail pharmaceuticals and other medical nondurables per capita, current US dollar purchasing power parities.

[c] Not updated: the 2018 counts (Daemmrich, 1982-2003, by originator country) have no current equivalent; EFPIA reports new chemical and biological entities for 2021-2025 only for the United States (140), Japan (33), and Europe as a whole (87).

[d] Not updated: the Bloomberg/SSR Health 2015 price comparison has not been repeated, and no single-methodology source compares monthly prices for these 4 products (now generic or biosimilar in most countries) across these countries.

[e] Retail pharmaceutical spending by financing scheme. US values are NA because employer and individual private insurance are now reported as compulsory schemes in the US health accounts, so public and private insurance shares are not comparable with 2018.

[f] Community (primary care) sector, defined daily doses per 1000 inhabitants per day; the United States reports prescriptions rather than defined daily doses.

[g] Market basis differs by country as in 2018: reimbursed market (Germany, Netherlands, Denmark, Australia), community pharmacy market (UK, France), total market (Canada, Japan, Switzerland, Sweden).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2019–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD Data Explorer (System of Health Accounts: retail pharmaceutical spending and financing; pharmaceutical market: generics); ECDC ESAC-Net and OECD (antibiotic consumption).

Figure 10. Access and Quality

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Access, %												
Able to get same- or next-day appointment[a]	NLD 50	Germany 49	CHE 43	UK 42	Australia 41	US 37	France 35	Sweden 30	Canada 24	Denmark NA	Japan NA	39 (n = 9)
2-mo Wait time to see specialist[a]	Canada 46	France 46	UK 42	Sweden 33	Australia 31	Germany 23	US 16	NLD 15	CHE 13	Denmark NA	Japan NA	29 (n = 9)
Adequate time with regular (primary) physician[b]	NLD 94	Australia 87	Germany 87	CHE 86	US 84	France 84	UK 73	Sweden 69	Canada 63	Denmark NA	Japan NA	81 (n = 9)
Perceptions, %												
System works well[c]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Fundamental changes needed	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Complete rebuild of health system needed	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Prevention												
Measles immunization, % of children	Japan 95	US 95	Denmark 94	France 93	Sweden 92	CHE 92	Germany 92	Australia 91	UK 84	NLD 81	Canada 79	90
Breast cancer screening, % of women aged 50-69 y	Denmark 82	Sweden 82	US 80	Canada 79	UK 70	NLD 66	Germany 66	Australia 52	CHE 50	France 47	Japan 45	65
Clinical outcomes												
30-d Stroke mortality per 100 admissions[d]	UK 8.5	CHE 7.9	Canada 7.6	France 7.3	Germany 7.0	Sweden 4.9	NLD 4.9	Denmark 4.9	US 4.5	Australia 4.1	Japan 2.1	5.8
30-d Mortality per 100 admissions with acute myocardial infarction	Germany 7.9	UK 6.4	CHE 6.2	France 5.5	US 5.2	Japan 4.9	Denmark 4.5	Canada 4.5	Sweden 3.4	Australia 3.3	NLD 2.9	5.0
Foreign body left per 100 000 discharges[e]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA
Obstetric trauma without instrument per 100 deliveries	Canada 4.0	Denmark 3.0	NLD 2.7	UK 2.3	CHE 1.9	US 1.7	Sweden 1.7	Australia 1.6	Germany 1.5	France NA	Japan NA	2.3 (n = 9)
Avoidable hospitalizations												
Diabetes hospitalizations per 100 000 population[f]	US 223.4	Germany 179.5	France 155.6	Australia 140.6	Canada 93.3	Denmark 86.2	CHE 82.6	UK 82.1	Sweden 60.4	NLD 42.3	Japan NA	114.6 (n = 10)
Diabetes hospitalizations as a ratio of population with diabetes[g]	France 2.39	Germany 2.30	Australia 1.90	US 1.63	CHE 1.56	Denmark 1.35	Canada 1.21	UK 1.11	Sweden 1.04	NLD 0.85	Japan NA	1.53 (n = 10)
Asthma hospitalizations per 100 000 population	UK 60.5	Denmark 59.0	Australia 52.0	France 29.8	Germany 27.2	NLD 25.1	CHE 23.0	US 22.4	Sweden 11.6	Canada 11.4	Japan NA	32.2 (n = 10)
Asthma hospitalizations as a ratio of population with asthma[h]	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	Sweden NA	France NA	NLD NA	CHE NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	NA

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Commonwealth Fund 2023 survey (Japan and Denmark not surveyed), computed from published response distributions on the 2016 base (same- or next-day appointment excluding those who did not need care; waited ≥2 months among those who saw or needed a specialist). Mode shifted toward online interviews in 2023.

[b] Mostly Commonwealth Fund 2020 survey data as published by OECD; Netherlands, national survey.

[c] Not updated: the health-system views question has not been asked in Commonwealth Fund general population surveys since 2016.

[d] Thirty-day in-hospital mortality per 100 admissions (unlinked data, age-sex standardized, ages ≥45 y), ischemic stroke and acute myocardial infarction. The 2018 labels read per 1000; values are per 100.

[e] Not updated: OECD discontinued the foreign-body-left-in indicator.

[f] Admissions with a primary diagnosis, persons aged ≥15 y, age-sex standardized.

[g] Admissions per 100 000 divided by diabetes prevalence (IDF Diabetes Atlas 2024, age-standardized, ages 20-79 y), shown per 100 persons with diabetes.

[h] Not updated: no official cross-national asthma prevalence series is available.

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2015–2025; most values 2020–2024); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: Commonwealth Fund International Health Policy Survey 2023 (respondent-level distributions published by the Canadian Institute for Health Information); OECD Data Explorer (Health Care Quality and Outcomes, immunisation, screening); IDF Diabetes Atlas 11th edition (diabetes prevalence).

Figure 11. Distribution and Equity

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Equity												
Horizontal inequity index, %[a]	US 5.30	Canada 2.20	France 1.10	Germany 0.80	NLD 0.50	UK 0.40	Sweden 0.30	Denmark -1.30	CHE NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	1.16 (n = 8)
Out-of-pocket spending												
As % of total health expenditure[b]	CHE 22.0	Australia 15.9	Canada 15.3	UK 14.6	Denmark 13.9	Sweden 13.4	Japan 12.2	NLD 11.8	US 10.9	Germany 10.7	France 9.2	13.6
As % of household consumption	CHE 3.8	Australia 3.2	Denmark 2.9	Sweden 2.8	US 2.5	NLD 2.4	Canada 2.3	Japan 2.2	UK 1.6	Germany 1.4	France 1.3	2.4
Unmet need[c]												
Consultation skipped because of cost	US 26.8	Australia 19.1	CHE 18.3	Canada 8.9	Sweden 6.3	NLD 4.7	UK 4.6	Germany 3.5	France 3.3	Denmark NA	Japan NA	10.6 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, below-average income	US 46	Australia 33	CHE 28	Canada 24	Sweden 19[f]	UK 16	Germany 16	France 16	NLD 16	Denmark NA	Japan NA	24 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, above-average income	US 29	Australia 25	CHE 18	Canada 12	UK 10	Germany 8	Sweden 6[f]	France 6	NLD 6	Denmark NA	Japan NA	13 (n = 9)
Geographic breakdown												
Rural population, % of total population	France 21	US 20	Germany 18	Canada 17	UK 17	CHE 14	Australia 12	Denmark 11	Sweden 11	Japan 8	NLD 4	14
Population density per sq km[d]	NLD 531	Japan 342	UK 283	Germany 238	CHE 225	Denmark 149	France 127	US 37	Sweden 26	Canada 5	Australia 4	179
Urban physicians per 1000 population[e]	CHE 5.4	Sweden 4.8	Australia 4.7	France 4.1	Japan 2.7	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	4.3 (n = 5)
Rural physicians per 1000 population	CHE 4.2	Sweden 4.2	Australia 3.3	France 2.7	Japan 2.6	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	3.4 (n = 5)

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Need-standardized horizontal inequity index ×100 for the probability of a physician visit in the past 12 months, by income (survey data 2014-2016). If greater than 0, high-income groups visit physicians more than low-income groups after adjustment for need.

[b] Share of current health expenditure.

[c] Commonwealth Fund 2023 survey: did not visit a physician, skipped a test, treatment, or follow-up, or did not fill a prescription or skipped doses because of cost in the past year, by self-reported household income below or above the national average. Consultation skipped because of cost: OECD (mostly 2020 Commonwealth Fund data).

[d] Persons per square kilometer of land; the 2018 label read per square mile but its values were also per square kilometer.

[e] Physicians per 1000 population in OECD predominantly urban vs predominantly rural small regions (TL3); only countries with TL3 physician data are shown (Germany excluded because its regional counts cover ambulatory physicians only).

[f] Sweden, 2020 survey (income data not collected in Sweden in 2023).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2014–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD, Health for Everyone? (2019) (horizontal inequity); WHO Global Health Expenditure Database via World Bank (out-of-pocket share); OECD System of Health Accounts (out-of-pocket share of household consumption); OECD Health Care Quality and Outcomes (consultation skipped); Commonwealth Fund International Health Policy Survey 2023 (unmet need); World Bank World Development Indicators (rural population, density); OECD Regional Statistics (urban and rural physicians).